The last time I was out I shot two hares four ducks and a goose. This is about the average of a days shooting here at this season, it is not much, but it is enough to amuse one and after all the exercise is the great thing. The days after Xmas day I was out and shot three Woodcocks two ducks and two snipe. Woodcocks are rare here and I believe I am the only man who ever shot three in a day. Since I hurt my knee I have been out once with the Prince, to see his hawks fly as this sport is carried on on horseback it suited me very well. The Prince by way of being civil ordered that I was to have all the hares which might be caught that day, they brought me six all caught by the dogs or shot. The first was caught in a manner which would be thought little better than poaching in England. The dogs, some pointers some mongrels, put it up and drove it towards the horsemen, the horsemen immediately began galloping their horses towards the hare and shouting like so many mad men, the hare was soon turned and went off in another direction and left the dogs, but there were horsemen in all directions and she was turned again and again and at last caught by the dogs.

As you, I dare say do not know much about hawking I will endeavour to describe how they mannage it here. The hawks they generally use are gos-hawks because they are more easily reclaimed than any other kind, and do not require to be carried hooded as falcons do; they have little bells on their legs and frequently a string with some beads or other ornament on their necks. The horseman with the hawk on his wrist always endeavours to get above the partridges if as is generally the case they are on the side of a hill, in doing this he frequently has to dash his horse up and down precipitate banks until he attains the summit of some cliff or rocky bank on the side of which are the partridges; he then begins to descend until he has flushed the birds, and he pitches his hawk giving it a swing off so as to set it in motion and it seldom fails to take one of the partridges which is taken from him, and the man mounts his horse and pursues the partridges in the same way again. If this hawk is flown at a pheasant which you know does not rise like a partridge but goes up perpendicularly, and as is generally the case he cannot reach the pheasant before the pheasant is above him, he lets the pheasant mount up into the air and continues flying quietly under him being quite certain that the pheasant must come down some time or other, the pheasant after he finds he can not escape by towering in the air makes a sudden dart to regain the thicket, then away goes the hawk after him and if he can seize the pheasant before the bird gets down into the bushes he is all right, but if once the bird gets again into the bushes it is almost impossible to flush him again as he knows very well that the hawk can do nothing to him as long as he continues running in the cover.

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